

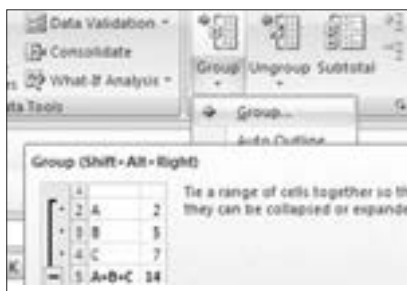
and the expanding and collapsing occur horizontally. You can also nest groups of cells as well, which is where the term “Level” becomes relevant. A nested groups of cells can only be accessed if the group encompassing it is expanded, just as in the case in Windows Explorer where the folders inside another can only be seen if the latter is expanded. The level denotes the order of nesting of the group.

To create Groups and Levels, you have the tools under the Outline Block in the Data tab. To create a group, select the range of cells and click on Group. You can then choose whether the group is to be created row-wise or column-wise. Depending on whether the grouping was done row-wise or column-wise, a set of controls appear on the left margin or the top margin of the spreadsheet. A set of buttons labelled 1 and 2 appears at one end—either the top of the left margin or the left end of the top margin. This set of buttons shows the levels of nested groups in the spreadsheet, and allows quick access to any specific level.

Excel supports up to eight levels of grouping, so the number of controls can go up to nine. Besides the buttons, the “+” and “-” controls, as in the Windows Explorer Folder Pane, also appear in the same area. The significance and use of the “plus” and “minus” controls are similar to those of their counterparts in Windows Explorer.

When you click on the Control with the largest number, you’ll reveal the ungrouped spreadsheet. As you click lower-number Controls, the nodes of those levels are expanded.

Many groups can be created in the same level, and you’d do well to create a



Group controls